

GETTING PAID NEPAL — [SANJAYAMAHARJANCODES.GITHUB.IO/GETTING-PAID-NEPAL](https://sanjayamaharjancodes.github.io/getting-paid-nepal)

Getting Paid in Nepal

Complete PDF Edition

A plain-language, consolidated guide for Nepali freelancers and IT exporters on legally receiving USD from Upwork, Fiverr, and international clients — plus two bonus checklists not published on the website.

\$9 one-time

Last reviewed: July 2026 · General information, not professional advice · © 2026 Getting Paid in Nepal

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How to use this PDF

Every fact in this PDF is also published, and kept current, on the live website at <https://sanjayamaharjancodes.github.io/getting-paid-nepal/>. Rules, fees, and platform availability change — treat the "last reviewed" date above as this snapshot's freshness, and check the live site or the relevant provider before relying on anything time-sensitive.

1. Overview — the short answer

You just landed a foreign client — on Upwork, Fiverr, or directly — and now you need to get the money into Nepal legally, without losing a big chunk to fees, and without a tax surprise later. This is a plain-language map of the rails that actually work for a Nepal-based individual in 2026, and just as important, the ones that don't.

For most Nepali freelancers and independent IT exporters, there are two rails worth taking seriously in 2026: **Payoneer** (the practical default for most freelancers, especially on Upwork/Fiverr) and a **direct bank SWIFT wire transfer** into your own Nepali bank account (better suited to larger, less frequent payments from direct clients). A few well-known global platforms — PayPal, Stripe, and Wise — are **not usable** for receiving money as a Nepal resident. Don't build a payment workflow around them.

Why this matters more than it looks like

Nepal Rastra Bank (NRB) — the central bank — regulates how foreign currency enters the country. A rail that isn't built for Nepal doesn't just "not work" — in some cases (PayPal, Stripe) it simply refuses Nepal-based recipients outright. Start with what is actually confirmed to work.

Quick comparison

Rail	Works for Nepal individuals?	Best for
Payoneer	Yes	Frequent freelance payouts, Upwork/Fiverr
Bank SWIFT wire	Yes, with correct paperwork	Larger, occasional payments from direct clients
PayPal	No	—
Stripe	No	—
Wise	No (not usable for receiving)	—

Getting the money into Nepal is only half the job — you're also expected to declare and pay tax on foreign income as a Nepali taxpayer. Chapter 5 covers what's publicly known, and clearly flags what's still unconfirmed.

General information, not professional advice

This guide provides general, plain-language information for Nepali freelancers and exporters. It is not legal, tax, banking, or financial advice, and rules change. Confirm anything that matters directly with the provider, your bank, the Inland Revenue Department (IRD), or a licensed professional before acting.

2. Payoneer in Nepal: complete setup guide

Payoneer is the payout method most Nepali freelancers on Upwork and Fiverr end up using — it's built to receive freelance-platform payouts and international client payments, and it withdraws directly to a Nepali bank account.

What Payoneer actually is

Payoneer is a global payments company that gives freelancers and small businesses a way to receive money from clients and platforms abroad, then move it to a local bank account. It handles a problem PayPal and Stripe don't solve here: getting USD (or other major currencies) out of a platform like Upwork or a direct client, and into a Nepali bank, through a route Nepal's banking system recognizes. When you sign up, you get receiving details in major currencies (commonly USD, EUR, GBP among others); clients or platforms pay into those as if paying a local account in that currency, and you withdraw the balance to your own bank, or in some cases spend it via a Payoneer card.

Why it's the default for Upwork/Fiverr freelancers here

Upwork and Fiverr both list Payoneer as a supported payout method for Nepal, and it's the most commonly used option among Nepali freelancers on those platforms.

Setting up Payoneer as a Nepal resident

The exact screens Payoneer shows change over time, so treat this as a map of the stages rather than a click-by-click script.

1. **Create your account.** Sign up with your legal name (matching your citizenship document / passport), a working email, and phone number. Most freelancers starting out use the individual account type.
2. **Identity verification (KYC).** Payoneer requires identity verification before you can withdraw funds — typically a government-issued ID and sometimes a proof-of-address step. This can take time to process; don't wait until you're expecting a payment to start it.
3. **Link your Nepali bank account.** Add your bank name, account number, and the details your bank requires for receiving a Payoneer withdrawal. A mismatched name between your Payoneer account and your bank account is a common cause of delayed or failed withdrawals.
4. **Connect Payoneer to Upwork/Fiverr** (if that's your use case). Inside your platform account settings, add Payoneer as your withdrawal/payout method.
5. **Receive and withdraw.** Once a client or platform pays into your Payoneer balance, withdraw to your linked Nepali bank account. Processing time and fees vary — check the current numbers inside your own Payoneer account before relying on a specific figure.

On fees and minimum withdrawal amounts

We deliberately don't quote a specific withdrawal fee percentage or minimum amount here, because Payoneer's published fees can change. Check the current fee schedule inside your own Payoneer account

before you rely on a number.

PAN and tax — a quick flag

Receiving money through Payoneer does not exempt you from Nepali tax obligations on foreign income. Nepali freelancers earning foreign income are generally expected to register for a Permanent Account Number (PAN) with the IRD and account for that income at tax time. See Chapter 5 before you assume any amount you receive is fully yours to spend.

Practical tips

- **Keep your name consistent.** Your Payoneer account, bank account, and government ID should match.
- **Don't wait for your first payment to start verification.** Identity verification can take a few business days.
- **Payoneer is built for frequent, smaller payments.** For one large, occasional payment, compare against a direct bank wire (Chapter 3).
- **Keep records.** Save your Payoneer statements and withdrawal confirmations for tax purposes.

General information, not professional advice

This guide describes general Payoneer mechanics and does not constitute financial, tax, or legal advice. Specific fees, minimums, required documents, and processing times are set by Payoneer and your bank and can change — verify current details directly with Payoneer and your bank.

3. Receiving USD via bank SWIFT wire transfer

For a large, one-off payment from a direct client — not a stream of small freelance-platform payouts — a direct wire straight into your Nepali bank account can work well. It also comes with a paperwork risk that catches people off guard: the bank has to correctly classify what the money is for.

How it works, in outline

A direct international client can instruct their bank to wire USD to your Nepali bank account via the SWIFT international payment network. Nepal's licensed commercial banks ("A-class" banks) are equipped to receive SWIFT wires — routine, established banking infrastructure. The part that requires care is not the wire mechanics, but how the receiving bank codes the inflow.

The classification risk

A documented, recurring problem is that inbound USD for IT/freelance services sometimes arrives at the bank **labelled as a personal remittance** rather than payment for services — and once that happens, it can be difficult to have it correctly recognized as service-export income after the fact.

[Reported by Nepal industry/trade press; well-corroborated but not primary-source-verified — confirm with your own bank.]

The practical takeaway: before you ask a client to wire you a meaningful amount, ask your bank's trade-services or foreign-exchange desk directly whether the inflow will be booked as **export-of-service proceeds against an invoice** — not as a personal remittance.

What the bank may ask for

- A copy of the **invoice** or contract the payment relates to
- Your **PAN** (tax registration) details
- Basic identification / proof of who you are and what the income relates to

[conf: medium — derived from account-opening document patterns across multiple Nepal banking guides, not confirmed with a specific bank's trade desk for individual freelancers specifically.]

The certificate you may want to ask about

Nepali banks can issue a certificate confirming that a foreign-currency inflow was received and realized against a specific invoice or purpose — commonly referred to regionally as a Foreign Inward Remittance Certificate (FIRC) or similar bank realization document. If you may need to prove the source of foreign income later, ask your bank whether they issue this and request one at the time of transfer. [conf: low-medium — concept well established regionally; exact Nepal-specific process not independently confirmed with a bank's trade desk.]

Which banks

Nepal's larger commercial banks generally have trade-services or foreign-exchange desks that handle this kind of inflow, including banks such as Standard Chartered Bank Nepal, Nabil Bank, NIC Asia Bank, and Global IME Bank, among others. We are not recommending one specific bank.

Regulatory environment is actively changing

Nepal's foreign-exchange rules for export proceeds have been amended more than once recently. [conf: medium — reported by Nepal legal/industry press; primary NRB circular text not independently opened by us.] Confirm current requirements with your bank before a large transfer.

When bank wire makes more sense than Payoneer

- A single large payment, rather than recurring smaller ones
- A direct client relationship (not a platform like Upwork/Fiverr)
- You want the funds to land directly in NPR without an intermediate USD balance

General information, not professional advice

Banking procedures, documentation requirements, and foreign-exchange regulations change and vary by bank. Confirm requirements directly with your bank's trade-services desk and, where relevant, a licensed advocate or chartered accountant.

4. How Upwork & Fiverr freelancers in Nepal get paid

If you're new to freelancing on Upwork or Fiverr from Nepal, the money doesn't move directly from your client's card to your Nepali bank account. It passes through a specific chain — platform escrow, then a payout method, then your bank.

The chain, step by step

1. **Client pays the platform.** On Upwork, a client funds a milestone or an hourly contract; the money sits with Upwork until work is approved and released (or, for hourly, the standard weekly billing cycle processes). Fiverr works similarly — the buyer pays up front, and funds clear to your Fiverr balance after order completion and any clearance period.
2. **Funds clear to your platform balance.** Both platforms hold funds for a period after work is marked complete before making them available for withdrawal — standard freelance-platform practice, giving both sides a window to resolve disputes.
3. **You withdraw to a payout method.** Upwork and Fiverr both list Payoneer as a supported withdrawal method for Nepal-based freelancers (Chapter 2). Check what's currently listed in your own account's payment settings.
4. **Payoneer to your Nepali bank.** Once funds land in your Payoneer balance, you withdraw to your linked Nepali bank account.

Where the delays usually happen

Delays are most often reported at two points: the platform's own clearance period, and identity-verification checks on the payout method (Payoneer) if not completed in advance. Starting your Payoneer verification before you need to withdraw your first payment avoids stacking both delays together.

Platform fees, in general terms

Upwork and Fiverr both take a service fee out of what the client pays before the balance reaches your account, and Payoneer may apply its own withdrawal fee on top when you move funds to your bank. We intentionally don't quote specific percentages here — fee structures change periodically and differ by contract type and freelancer tier. Check the current fee schedule inside your own accounts.

Setting your rates with the full chain in mind

A common mistake is pricing a project based on the client-facing rate, without accounting for platform fees and payout fees stacking on top of each other. Work backward from what you actually want to land in your Nepali bank account.

PAN, invoicing, and tax records

Even though Upwork and Fiverr handle client-facing invoicing, you're still responsible for your own Nepali tax position on that income. Keep your own record of what you were paid and when —

platform statements plus Payoneer withdrawal records are generally enough to reconstruct your income history if needed.

General information, not professional advice

Platform fee structures, payout method availability, and clearance periods are set by Upwork, Fiverr, and Payoneer respectively and can change without notice.

5. Tax on foreign income for freelancers in Nepal

This is the chapter most guides skip, and it's the one that matters most once the money actually lands in your account. We're unusually direct here about what we do and don't know — please read the caveats, not just the headline numbers.

This chapter is general information, not professional advice

Nothing here is tax, legal, or accounting advice, and nothing here should be treated as a final answer about what you owe. Nepali tax law and its interpretation change, and your specific situation changes the answer. Before you file, talk to a licensed Nepali chartered accountant or contact the IRD directly.

The basic obligation

Nepali tax law expects residents to declare income, including foreign-sourced income such as freelance earnings from abroad. In practice, this generally means registering for a PAN with the IRD and filing/reporting your income — a widely described general practice, not something we have verified against a specific IRD regulation ourselves.

On the specific tax rate — not settled law

You will see a figure of around

5%

mentioned in various freelancer guides and accounting blogs as a presumptive or "final" tax rate applied to foreign freelance/IT-export income for individuals.

We are not stating this as confirmed, settled law.

We have not independently verified this figure against a current IRD source, and rates and how they're applied can differ by situation and can change between fiscal years. Treat ~5% as something to confirm with your accountant, not a number to plan finances around unconfirmed.

A separate, larger-scale provision (also unconfirmed by us at the individual level)

Nepal's national budget for the 2026–27 fiscal year reportedly introduced an income-tax exemption on the export portion of IT-service earnings — described in secondary reporting as roughly **50%**, said to have been reduced from a larger exemption the prior fiscal year. **We have not independently confirmed whether, or exactly how, this applies to an individual freelancer** on Upwork/Fiverr as opposed to a registered exporting company — and because it's a budget figure, it can be revised in a future budget. Don't assume it applies to your situation without checking with an accountant.

What you should actually do

1. Register for a PAN with the IRD if you haven't already.
2. Keep clean records: platform statements, Payoneer or bank statements, and copies of invoices/contracts.
3. Talk to a chartered accountant who works with freelancers or IT exporters specifically.

4. Re-check current numbers before you rely on them — a government budget or IRD circular can move faster than any single guide.

Once more, plainly

We are not tax professionals, this is not tax advice, and the specific figures mentioned above (~5%, ~50%) are things you're likely to see in your own research, not confirmed facts to rely on financially. Talk to a real accountant before you file.

6. Payment method comparison and FAQ

Method	Works for Nepal?	Typical use case	Notes
Payoneer	Yes	Upwork/Fiverr payouts, recurring income	The default for most Nepali freelancers on major platforms.
Bank SWIFT wire	Yes, with correct paperwork	Larger one-off payments	Risk of misclassification as personal remittance if paperwork isn't right.
PayPal	No	—	Does not support payouts to Nepal-based accounts.
Stripe	No	—	Nepal not a supported country for Stripe accounts/payouts.
Wise	No (for receiving)	—	Does not currently offer Nepal-resident receiving accounts.
Skrill / other niche	Not verified by us	—	Confirm directly with the provider before agreeing to use one.

Decision guide

Your situation	Recommended rail
Freelancing on Upwork or Fiverr	Payoneer
Direct client, one large payment	Bank SWIFT wire
Direct client, recurring smaller payments	Payoneer (many direct clients can also pay into Payoneer)
Client insists on PayPal, Stripe, or Wise	Propose Payoneer or bank wire instead

FAQ

Can I use PayPal at all if I'm based in Nepal?

Not for receiving payments into a Nepal-based account. PayPal does not support payouts to Nepal.

What about a Payoneer business account instead of an individual one?

Payoneer supports both individual and registered-business account types. Most freelancers starting out use the individual type; check directly with Payoneer on how the two compare on fees.

Is a bank wire ever cheaper than Payoneer?

It can be, especially for a single large payment, since Payoneer's percentage-based withdrawal fee scales with the amount while a bank wire's cost structure is different. Check current fees on both sides before committing.

Why isn't there a Wise guide?

Because, as far as we've confirmed, Wise does not currently offer Nepal-resident receiving accounts — a setup guide would be describing something you can't actually do.

7. Bonus checklist — Payoneer account setup

Not published on the website. A tick-as-you-go list for opening and verifying a Payoneer account as a Nepal resident, built from the setup steps and practical tips in Chapter 2.

- ☐ Gather a government-issued ID (citizenship certificate or passport) matching your legal name
- ☐ Confirm your legal name is spelled identically across your ID, your bank account, and the Payoneer account you're about to open
- ☐ Have a working email address and phone number ready for signup
- ☐ Decide account type — individual vs. registered business (most freelancers starting out: individual)
- ☐ Create your Payoneer account
- ☐ Start identity verification (KYC) immediately — don't wait until a payment is due
- ☐ Have a proof-of-address document ready in case it's requested
- ☐ Add your Nepali bank account details (bank name, account number) — double-check for typos before submitting
- ☐ Confirm the name on your bank account matches your Payoneer account exactly
- ☐ Once approved, note your Payoneer receiving account details (USD, EUR, GBP, etc.)
- ☐ If using Upwork/Fiverr: add Payoneer as your payout/withdrawal method in the platform's settings
- ☐ Confirm the platform-to-Payoneer connection completed successfully
- ☐ Before your first withdrawal: check the current withdrawal fee and minimum amount inside your own Payoneer account — not from any outside guide, since these change
- ☐ Save your Payoneer statements and withdrawal confirmations for tax record-keeping
- ☐ Register for a PAN with the IRD if you haven't already — needed regardless of payout method

Note

This checklist reflects the general setup flow described in Chapter 2 — the exact screens Payoneer shows change over time, so follow what's actually on screen when you sign up, and treat this as your master list to check off alongside it.

8. Bonus checklist — bank-visit / SWIFT documentation

Not published on the website. What to bring and what to ask before a SWIFT wire, built from the classification-risk and documentation guidance in Chapter 3.

- ☐ Identify which of your bank's branches/desks handles trade-services or foreign exchange (call ahead — not every branch does)
- ☐ Before the wire: call the trade-services desk and ask directly whether the inflow will be booked as export-of-service proceeds against an invoice — not as a personal remittance
- ☐ Prepare a copy of the invoice or contract the payment relates to
- ☐ Have your PAN (tax registration) details ready
- ☐ Bring basic ID / proof of who you are and what the income relates to
- ☐ Ask whether the bank issues a Foreign Inward Remittance Certificate (FIRC) or equivalent realization certificate — and request it at the time of the transfer, not after the fact
- ☐ Ask about the bank's current wire-receiving fees before committing to this rail for a specific amount
- ☐ Ask whether there's a repatriation or reporting window relevant to this transfer
- ☐ After the wire lands: confirm with the bank it was coded correctly (export proceeds, not personal remittance) — don't assume, ask
- ☐ Keep copies of everything: the invoice, any certificate issued, and the bank's confirmation of receipt, for your tax records

Note

Bank practice and documentation requirements vary by bank and change over time (Chapter 3). Use this checklist as a starting point for the conversation with your own bank's trade-services desk, not as a guarantee of what any specific bank will require.

About this PDF

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